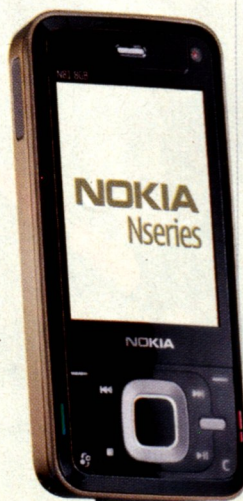




Tectonic SHIFT

The year saw technology put to its worst use—killing people and attempting mass destruction—in the Mumbai terror attacks. Little do we realise that satellite phones and GPS systems can be agents of such change. But technology enables. 2008 also brought high-definition TVs right in our homes. Green was the order of the day and nobody wanted to be seen as leaving a carbon footprint or contributing to global warming. So cars went hybrid and everything from house lights to laptop screens and TVs were suddenly LED in another direction. Here are some of the best innovations and gadgets that hit the shelves in the past year.



Apple Macbook Air
Rs 96,100

Flash Memory & Solid State Drives

Storage media have become so small that they can be implanted in the brain. As memory became smaller physically, capacities became bigger during the year.

Electronics, ranging from camcorders and laptops to mobile phones and MP3 players, now have high capacity on-board memory up to 16GB. These can store huge amounts of data and can transfer it at high speeds. The smaller the device, the smaller is the size of the storage media. Laptops have ditched the usual hard disks and moved to solid state drives to keep themselves slim and less bulky.

 **Nokia N81 8GB**
Rs 15,600